CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 5

Surah Al-Fatihah: *Ayat 5*

Thursday, 25 June 2026 | Iyyaka na'budu wa iyyaka nasta'in | The turning point of Al-Fatihah

IN SHORT

- "Only You we worship, only You we ask" — obey first, then ask.
- Ibadah is everything Allah loves, including small kindnesses.
- Worship is incomplete if we harm people; the best deed is the most sincere.

1. Text & meaning

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

"Hanya kepada Engkau kami menyembah, dan hanya kepada Engkau kami memohon pertolongan."

WORD BY WORD

5

إِيَّاكَ	نَعْبُدُ	وَإِيَّاكَ	نَسْتَعِينُ
hanya kepada Engkau	kami menyembah	dan hanya kepada Engkau	kami memohon pertolongan

Hanya kepada Engkau kami menyembah, dan hanya kepada Engkau kami memohon pertolongan.

2. The pivot of Al-Fatihah

Ayat 1–4 are **praise of Allah**; ayat 5–7 are **the servant's side of the covenant**. The surah is divided between Allah and His servant — and this ayat is the border (hadis qudsi, Muslim 395).

TWO GRAMMAR POINTS THAT CARRY 'AQIDAH

1. **Putting the object first** (*iyyaka*) gives exclusivity (*hasr*): "**only** You" — not just "we worship You". It rules out shirk in worship **and** in reliance.
2. **The deliberate order:** *na'budu* before *nasta'in* — worship first, then asking for help. We give (obey) before we ask.

3. What is ibadah?

الْعِبَادَةُ اسْمٌ جَامِعٌ لِكُلِّ مَا يُحِبُّهُ اللَّهُ وَيَرْضَاهُ مِنَ الْأَقْوَالِ وَالْأَعْمَالِ الظَّاهِرَةِ وَالْبَاطِنَةِ

"Ibadah ialah nama yang merangkumi segala yang Allah cintai dan redhai, sama ada perkataan atau perbuatan, zahir dan batin."

IBN TAYMIYYAH, MAJMU' AL-FATAWA 10/149

Ibadah isn't only solat. Anything done for Allah and in line with the sunnah counts: solat, puasa, zakat, seeking knowledge, being good to parents, helping people, smiling at your brother, easing someone's hardship.

SMALL DEEDS, BIG VALUE WITH ALLAH

PRACTICE	DALIL
A smile is sedekah — تَبَسُّمُكَ فِي وَجْهِ أَخِيكَ لَكَ صَدَقَةٌ	Tirmidhi 1956 · sahih (al-Albani)
Removing a thorny branch from the road → forgiven and entered Jannah	Abu Dawud 5245 (wording from the class) · hasan sahih; same meaning in Bukhari 652 and Muslim 1914
A prostitute gave water to a thirsty dog — and was forgiven	Bukhari 3321; Muslim 2245 · Sahih

> **Never look down on small deeds. Ikhlas is what makes a deed big with Allah.**

ارْحَمُوا مَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَرْحَمْكُمْ مَنْ فِي السَّمَاءِ

"Kasihanilah makhluk di bumi, nescaya Yang di langit akan merahmati kamu."

TIRMIDHI 1924 · SAHIH

4. The deen rests on two relationships

حَبْلٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ — WITH ALLAH	حَبْلٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ — WITH PEOPLE
Solat · puasa · zikir · ikhlas · tawakkal	Good to parents · caring for neighbours · helping those in need · keeping amanah · spreading rahmah

Worship of Allah isn't complete if people's rights are trampled.

*The Prophet ﷺ was told of a woman known for much night prayer, fasting and sedekah, **but who hurt her neighbours** with her tongue. He said: "Dia di dalam neraka." Then of a woman who did only the obligatory prayers and gave small sedekah, **but didn't hurt her neighbours**. He said: "Dia di dalam syurga."*

AL-ADAB AL-MUFRAD 119 (ABU HURAIRAH) · SAHIH (AL-ALBANI)

5. The best deed: sincere and following the sunnah

الَّذِي خَلَقَ الْمَوْتَ وَالْحَيَاةَ لِيَبْلُوَكُمْ أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا

"(Dialah) yang menciptakan mati dan hidup untuk menguji kamu, siapakah antara kamu yang paling baik amalannya."

AL-MULK 67:2

The salaf understood *ahsanu 'amala* as the most **sincere** and most **in line with the sunnah** — not the most in quantity. The ayat says *ahsan* (best), not *akthar* (most).

EXAMPLES OF SUNNAH

PRACTICE	DETAILS	REFERENCE
Du'a between azan & iqamah	The du'a between azan and iqamah is not rejected	Abu Dawud 521; Tirmidhi 212 · Sahih
Sunat before Subuh	Rakaat 1: al-Kafirun · Rakaat 2: al-Ikhlas	Muslim 726 · Sahih
Sunat before Subuh & after Maghrib	The Prophet ﷺ often recited al-Kafirun and al-Ikhlas in both	An-Nasa'i 992 (Ibn 'Umar) · Sahih (al-Albani)

> The best deed isn't the most — it's the most sincere and the most faithful to the sunnah.

From class: be wary of viral "read this X times to get Y" content with no dalil. The authenticated daily sunnah is already more than anyone can do in a day — there's no need to invent new formulas.

6. The deeds most beloved to Allah

أَحَبُّ النَّاسِ إِلَى اللَّهِ أَنْفَعُهُمْ لِلنَّاسِ

"Manusia yang paling dicintai Allah ialah yang paling bermanfaat kepada manusia. Dan amalan yang paling dicintai Allah ialah kegembiraan yang engkau masukkan ke dalam hati seorang Muslim, atau engkau hilangkan kesusahannya, atau engkau lunaskan hutangnya, atau engkau hilangkan laparnya."

AT-TABARANI, AL-AWSAT · HASAN/SAHIH (AL-ALBANI: SAHIH IN AL-SILSILAH AL-SAHIHAH 906; HASAN LI-GHAYRIHI IN SAHIH AL-TARGHIB 2623)

ABU BAKR R.A.

- He'll be **called from every gate of Jannah** because of his many good deeds (Bukhari 1897; Muslim 1027).
- **Al-Lail 92:17–18** — "the most pious, who gives his wealth to purify himself": many mufassirin say this refers to Abu Bakr, who spent his wealth freeing slaves tortured for Islam.
- From class: Abu Bakr is remembered not for qiyam or khatam, but for his **infaq** — worship through wealth can be what defines you before Allah.

7. Why we were created

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ ۝ مَا أُرِيدُ مِنْهُم مِّن رِّزْقٍ وَمَا أُرِيدُ أَن يُطْعِمُونِ ۝ إِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الرَّزَّاقُ ذُو الْقُوَّةِ الْمَتِينُ

"Dan tidak Aku ciptakan jin dan manusia melainkan untuk menyembah-Ku. Aku tidak menghendaki rezeki daripada mereka, dan Aku tidak menghendaki mereka memberi-Ku makan. Sesungguhnya Allah, Dialah Pemberi rezeki, Yang mempunyai kekuatan lagi Maha Kukuh."

ADH-DHARIYAT 51:56–58

1. Rezeki comes **from Allah**.
2. The means must still be **pursued**, while the heart depends on Allah.
3. **Tawakkal doesn't cancel effort.**

Reflections

- **Give before you ask.** *Na'budu* comes before *nasta'in*. We often come to Allah with a list of requests before any commitment of obedience — the ayat reverses that order.
- **Ibadah is wide.** If ibadah is everything Allah loves, then our daily work, done honestly and for His sake, is worship too.
- **Two ropes, both needed.** Strong with Allah but harsh with people — or kind to people but careless with Allah — both fall short. The hadith of the two women is the sharpest warning.
- **Allah needs nothing from us** (51:57). Every sedekah and act of help is for people's benefit — so there's no room to feel we've done Him a favour.

Personal notes from the Tadabbur class (Siri 5), compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم